

SEALED SOLUTION

Stop here until you commit.

This file reveals the investigation, the identities, and the ending. Keep it separate from the player packet.

Before continuing, write your conclusion, cite the records that support it, and name an uncertainty the file does not resolve.

Read the evidence-cited solution first. The expanded aftermath follows the original ending. It develops the human consequences; it does not supply a clue needed to solve the case.

A blank reverse follows this cover so the first answer starts on a fresh sheet when this file is printed on both sides.

SPOILER BARRIER

The answer is overleaf.

Keep this file closed until your written reconstruction is complete.

The person beneath the memorial

Miriam Cross, born Miriam Dale, is the documented occupant of G17. She was Roscoe Hale's mother, Edith Hale's mother-in-law and Ada Reeve's paternal grandmother. The apparent second woman is not evidence of a second wife.

Follow the body through the records. R02 directs you to interment I-431. R04 names account U-572 and seal S44, delivered to Harbor Rest G17. R05 matches all three identifiers and supplies the full name Miriam Cross and death entry D-89. R06 is that death registration. This is a positive documentary chain, not an inference from initials alone.

Distinguish the other candidates. Mabel Cross belongs to U-573, seal S45 and North Field B6 (R05); the matching surname and nearby date do not merge the two coffins. Marion's death is Bayhaven D-204 (R03), not the Briarport D-89 linked to G17. The case does not require proving that no other M. Cross existed.

Keep the claim proportional. R02 and R15 define a complete recorded-activity review for this plot through 16 June 1937. They support one recorded coffin interment, with no recorded removal. No exhumation or biological identification has taken place.

The family and the two plots

Dale becomes Hale. R10 records Miriam Dale, born 29 July 1858, daughter of Elias Dale and Hannah formerly Boyd, marrying Jonas Hale in 1879. R09 records their son Roscoe, born 18 April 1881.

Hale becomes Cross. R11 identifies the bride as Miriam Hale, formerly Dale, widowed after Jonas's death. Its exact birth date and parent pair match R10 and R06. She marries William Cross in 1888. R12's Roscoe-as-step-son is consistent with this chain; the census alone would not establish it.

Roscoe's own family. R13 names Edith Winn as Roscoe's bride and Miriam Cross as his mother. R15 identifies their daughter Ada and her later married name Reeve. Miriam is therefore Ada's grandmother, not a rival claimant to the role of Roscoe's wife.

Edith is already next door. R15 places her 1937 burial in G18, not G17. R14 reserved that adjoining space for her. Adding her name as if her coffin were in G17 would blur a distinction the registers preserve.

A grave made around an absence

There was no burial when Roscoe's stone was raised. R07 expressly orders a memorial stone and foundation only. R08 reports the vessel loss, a concluded search and no identifiable human remains. R02's Roscoe entry points to the stone book, not the interment book.

Miriam chose this place and this memorial. Her instructions in R14 request the first coffin burial in G17 and retention of the existing name. She specifically asks that her own name be entered honestly in the burial book. Edith signs the corresponding permission. The evidence supports remembrance, not a concealed second marriage or a coffin exchange.

Acceptable additional wording: "Miriam Cross, born Dale, 1858-1931, mother of Roscoe Hale, rests here. This stone also commemorates Roscoe, presumed lost at sea in 1912; no remains were recovered in the recorded search." A separate reference may identify Edith's adjoining G18 grave. Equivalent wording earns full credit if it preserves the distinctions.

What remains open: the location of Roscoe's remains and the exact circumstances of his loss. The packet also cannot show what every family member knew. A sea-loss inquiry does not become a witnessed death simply because a memorial carries dates.

Ada asks the mason for a smaller tablet. She keeps Roscoe's name. Beneath it, at last, she gives his mother hers.

The closing scene is narrative resolution. Every required identity and explanation is supported in the player packet.

AFTER THE CASE

Enough room for both

After the original solution and ending

Ada brought the proposed tablet back to Lydia before she took it to the mason. Miriam Cross. Born Dale. The woman the records connected to Roscoe as his mother and to Ada as her paternal grandmother.

"Will this do?" she asked.

Lydia checked the names and dates against the extracts. "The details agree. Whether it says what you want is yours to decide."

Ada had hoped, absurdly, that the records could finish that decision too.

At Harbor Rest, she stood between G17 and G18 with the paper in her hand. Miriam's burial in one. Edith's in the other. Roscoe remembered above a plot that had first been prepared as a memorial, without his remains. The arrangement was comprehensible at last. Being comprehensible did not make it painless.

She had begun the inquiry wanting to complete her mother's inscription. She had ended it responsible for a name her mother had permitted the book to preserve while the stone spoke of someone else. Ada could recognize the tenderness of that arrangement and refuse to repeat its imbalance.

At Holt & Son, she asked for the separate tablet. Roscoe's name would stay. Miriam's would be visible. Edith's place would be correctly identified.

The mason repeated the wording back to her, slowly. When he reached Miriam, Ada heard how unfamiliar the name still was in her own voice. A relationship could be proved in an afternoon of papers and still take time to become part of a life.

"I thought I knew what I was ordering," she said.

He set his pencil down. "Now you do."

She did not tell him that knowing the order was easier than knowing what to say to her mother. There was no one left to ask whether Edith had meant to protect her, assumed she knew, or simply allowed one unfinished conversation to become years. The surviving papers did not resolve that private history. Nor did they locate Roscoe's remains or establish an exact witnessed death.

Ada folded the approved wording around the copies of the records. She would keep both. One told her what to put on the stone. The other showed why the name belonged there.

The completed memorial would not make the sea return anyone. It would make one quieter correction on shore: a woman remembered for herself in the place where she had chosen to remain near the son she could not bring home.